

GlobeGrid — v8.16.0 build report

A ~60-item owner update · 2026-07-13 · commit `d8d8bd6` on branch `claude/globegrid-setup-phase-1-ja960a`

Verified in-sandbox: 35/35 unit tests green · fresh DB boots clean (216 countries, 71,959 admin units, 4 new conflicts seeded, all source leanings valid) · every new HTTP endpoint returns 200 · headless Chromium loads the v8.16.0 badge with 5 tracker cards and **0 non-network console errors**. The AI-dependent paths (analyst, translation, prediction-market fetch) stay proxy-blocked in the sandbox and degrade cleanly, exactly as designed.

1. Live tracking windows new

A new  **trackers** header hub opens five focused monitors. Each window states its data layer honestly — **LIVE** (streaming events / sensors / market odds) vs **CURATED** (year-and-source-labelled statistics).

Window	Endpoint	What it shows
Military tracker	<code>/api/military</code>	Live military/conflict events with precise coordinates + physical-sensor tracks (OpenSky/AIS/FIRMS/USGS, key-gated ones labelled) + a curated standing force-posture layer.
Trade & resources	<code>/api/trade</code> , <code>/api/trade/{iso3}</code>	21 curated trade profiles (exports/imports/partners/top-goods), world totals + chokepoints, resources & industry, and a live trade-news trail. Also the country page's Trade tab.
Markets	<code>/api/markets/live</code>	Live market/finance events + the hourly market briefing.
Prediction markets	<code>/api/predmarkets</code>	Real-money geopolitics odds from Polymarket + Kalshi public APIs (60s cache, no keys). Also a War Mode public-sentiment strip.
Diplomatic window	<code>/api/diplomacy?a=&b=</code>	Any two countries: current stance, background briefs, and their shared live-coverage trail.

New backend: `routes_tracking.py`, `trade_data.py`, `ideology.py`, `predmarkets.py`; frontend `Trackers.js`.

2. Categorization & conflict-tagging overhaul

- **A normative category contract** (`category_defs.py`) — one paragraph per category — injected into the LLM reviewer and surfaced in the ? guide.
- **Domestic retuned** to "random national news" (sports, culture, local) — the macro-financial and national-election words were removed, and the tie-break priority now puts finance + geopolitics *above* domestic. Geopolitics widened so cross-border stories stop falling into "other".
- **Conflict tagging tightened:** a FROZEN conflict now requires its literal name in the text (Transnistria tags only Transnistria news, not shared-belligerent Kadyrov or NATO-summit stories); active conflicts get a both-parties-literally-named boost (more Ukraine-war news lands on the Ukraine war). The weak "suggested conflict" confirm UI is **removed** entirely.
- **An LLM wire editor** (`curate.py`): reviews recent event titles (grammar / translation / de-linking / specificity) and re-checks each category — with a deterministic cleanup that runs even with no model.
- **Impacted-country chips, precise:** a scan of the story's own text for literally-named countries/blocs, so an Iran story shows Iran/Israel and never Greenland. 1–2 chips nest in each feed card; a NATO chip flies the real NATO flag.

3. Country panel → horizontal tabs

Sections nest into browser-like tabs (Overview / Government / Diplomacy / Conflicts / Trade / Divisions / Coverage) under the flag + leader header, so users stop scrolling endlessly. Legislature seat dots **and** the EU parliament are now clickable to the party dossier. Limited-recognition states with real elected chambers get the graphic (Kosovo, Northern Cyprus, Somaliland; Palestine / Abkhazia / S. Ossetia get honest notes). City pages lost their flag; the internal "Natural Earth" source string is hidden.

4. Map data corrections

- **Ideology map mode** — ruling-party ideology per country (curated, mid-2026), with a red → blue political-spectrum palette.
- **East-Asia religion redo** — Japan → Shinto, Korea → Buddhism, China/Vietnam/HK → folk/Buddhist (not "Unaffiliated").
- **Alawite** is its own sect (its own hue, not a Shia shade).
- **Relative-percentage shading** — religion/sect map opacity follows the dominant tradition's population share.
- **Telugu dialect regions** (Uttarandhra / Kosta / Rayalaseema) split at the district tier; **Kvemo Kartli** reads Georgian; the government-mode tooltip no longer leaks the previous mode's values; Abkhazia & South Ossetia stay `de_facto`.

5. UI/UX pass

Area	Change
Shortcuts	F = command palette (was Ctrl/Cmd+K), N = feed, L = list view, Shift+L = next language, ? = startup guide; right-click-drag = alternative rectangle select.
Live feed	New arrivals pile in from the TOP; on-screen cards keep their position (an update pulses in place, no jump).
Fonts	Map/globe labels now follow the Settings font (both renderers gained a real <code>setLabelFont</code> — the call was previously a no-op).
Borders	No longer phase out on deep zoom (the globe line shader's limb fade was hugging too much of the close-up frame).
Breaking news	Fires instantly — the story card carries its peak severity, so the toast + fanfare no longer wait for a map refresh.
Autonomous zones	Draw REAL admin-unit geometry only (the rectangle fallback is deleted); Wales / Scotland / Northern Ireland added as devolved zones with full profiles + real boundaries.
Flags	Separatist-flag suppression extended to IRN/TUR/SYR/IRQ/AZE (no Khuzestan / Kurdistan / "South Azerbaijan"); all Pakistani provinces now carry a curated official flag.
War Mode	A distinctive drum+horn entry cue; belligerents vs supporters get slightly different outlining with a  supporters toggle; the audio briefing reads ONLY that conflict's own feed.

6. Data breadth & honesty

- **Four new conflicts:** Israel–Hezbollah, Yemen Civil War, Libyan Civil War, South China Sea Dispute (each with correct parties + backers).
- **26 new regional/tech news sources** (Africa, S. America, S/SE/Central Asia, Oceania, Arab world, Turkey, Caucasus, Iran + worldwide tech) — duplicates of already-seeded outlets pruned.
- **Agenda stops forcing a bloc** on countries in real realignment: Armenia moved east → nonaligned with a curated transitional line after the Artsakh betrayal (Georgia/Serbia too).
- **Dynamic leader refresh** runs 2×/hour with a larger batch; legislature compositions carry a staleness flag (>450 days). War-mode thread breakdowns link to the real thread page.

7. Verification detail

Tests: `python run_tests.py` → 35/35 OK (includes the retuned classifier, the widened SUBNATIONAL-key integrity check, and the extended Pakistani/separatist flag pins).

Boot: fresh DB, no non-benign errors in the log; 4 new conflicts confirmed seeded.

HTTP: `/api/military`, `/api/trade[USA]`, `/api/markets/live`, `/api/predmarkets`, `/api/ideologies`, `/api/diplomacy`, `/api/mapmodes/ideology`, `/api/mapmodes/religion` (shares present) — all 200. Ideology: USA = "Right-wing populism", 15 categories. TWN + Kosovo legislatures render. UK devolved zones present.

Chip precision: Iran story → [Iran, Israel] (no Greenland); NATO story → NATO (with flag) + Russia.

Headless Chromium: badge v8.16.0, 5 tracker cards, 0 non-network console errors, both renderers exercised.